

CHRISTIAN MATTHEWS

Network Engineer & Infrastructure Architect

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TECHNICAL PROFILE

Senior network engineer and infrastructure architect with 15 years of hands-on, end-to-end experience from endpoint to cloud. Strong team lead and individual contributor across enterprise networking, SD-WAN, server and virtualization (VMware ESXi / vSphere / vCenter, Hyper-V), Windows Server, and Azure. Deep platform fluency in Aruba (including Aruba Central), VMware SD-WAN (VeloCloud), Cradlepoint, and Cisco Catalyst / Meraki, with working architectural exposure to Palo Alto and Fortinet at the customer edge. Prior experience across manufacturing, healthcare, hospitality, and national carrier environments.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Routing & Switching: Aruba (CX, AOS-Switch), Cisco Catalyst, Cisco Meraki, L2/L3 design, VLANs, trunking, STP design, static routing, inter-VLAN routing

SD-WAN & WAN Edge: VMware SD-WAN (VeloCloud / VMware Edge), Cisco Meraki SD-WAN, Cradlepoint LTE/5G failover, MPLS-to-SD-WAN migrations, dual-circuit/active-active design

Wireless & Cloud-Managed: Aruba Central, Aruba Instant / controller-based, Cisco Meraki, enterprise SSID design, RF planning for manufacturing and healthcare environments

Edge Security & Firewalls: Fortinet FortiGate, Palo Alto Networks (PAN-OS), interface-level / architectural exposure across customer edge designs; site-to-site & remote-access VPN, IPsec, segmentation, zero-trust patterns, vulnerability management (Tenable)

Voice & Telephony: Cisco IAD (Integrated Access Device), Sonus GSX softswitch, Lucent 5ESS / Nortel DMS Class 5 TDM, SIP / VoIP, traditional TDM-to-IP migrations, Microsoft Teams Telephony / Direct Routing, EnGenius DECT, carrier-side voice support

Server & Virtualization: Windows Server (AD DS, DNS, DHCP, GPO, file / print, certificate services), VMware ESXi / vSphere / vCenter, Hyper-V, server hardware (Supermicro, Dell, HPE), patching, backup, on-prem-to-cloud lift-and-shift, P2V, and V2V.

Identity & Cloud: Active Directory / GPO, Entra ID (Azure AD) hybrid identity, Azure VNets, Azure Virtual Desktop (AVD), conditional access, and hybrid infrastructure environments with on-prem and cloud app servers.

Endpoints & Workflow: Clinical PIMS integration, specialized medical endpoint cutovers, EUC standardization, M365 / Power Platform

Tooling & Automation: ServiceNow, Atlassian Jira / Jira Service Management, ScienceLogic SL1, Power Automate, AI Builder, Dataverse

Methodology: ITIL Foundation, runbook-driven cutovers, change management, structured QA and audit

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA), Routing & Switching, Cisco Networking Academy
- ITIL Foundation, PeopleCert (2022)
- A.S., Network Systems Management, Florence-Darlington Technical College (Dean's List, Tech Stars Scholarship)
- Cisco Networking Certificate; Fundamentals of Networking Certificate, Florence-Darlington Technical College

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Burwood Group

Remote / National

Team Lead, Burwood Managed Services, NOC & Service Desk Operations

Jan 2026 to Present

Player-coach role: hands-on technical lead and architect across NOC and Service Desk while owning service operations standards.

- **Technical escalation:** Serve as senior technical escalation point across Aruba, Cisco Catalyst / Meraki, and SD-WAN environments for managed service customers, including County of Orange voice infrastructure.
- **Platform build:** Designed and shipped an automated ticket QA platform (Power Automate + AI Builder GPT-4.1 + Dataverse), concept to production in under 90 days, scoring closed ServiceNow tickets nightly with rubric-based feedback.
- **Security architecture:** Identified vulnerability and patch management gaps and built the technical case for a Tenable-based visibility program across switches, endpoints, and network infrastructure.
- **Operational tooling:** Refactored ServiceNow dashboards, fixed broken parent/child ticket logic distorting SLA metrics, and corrected ScienceLogic SL1 deep-link generation so engineers land directly on the affected device.
- **Infrastructure cost:** Re-engineered jumpbox standard, replacing oversized Supermicro mini-servers with right-sized hardware where ECC was unnecessary, halving per-site spend.

Team Lead, Enterprise Networking & Field Services

Feb 2024 to Dec 2025

Program lead and player-coach across Enterprise Networking delivery while standing up Field Services as an in-house deployment arm.

- **Architecture leadership:** Lead architect on Enterprise Networking engagements spanning Aruba campus refreshes, VMware SD-WAN (VeloCloud) deployments, Cisco Meraki rollouts, and Cradlepoint LTE failover, and V2V/P2V lift and shift server migrations, for mid-market and enterprise customers.
- **Presales engineering:** Hands-on presales validation against solutions architects, auditing BoMs, circuit designs, SD-WAN policy templates, and edge security posture while protecting practice margin
- **M&A delivery:** Adapted proprietary M&A migration runbook for an \$800M VC-backed financial services client, enabling rapid multi-state acquisition integration with minimal downtime.
- **Practice creation:** Built Field Services from concept to a 20-person deployment team to replace third-party contractors and recapture margin on rack-and-stack, Smart Hands, and remote cutover support.
- Primary technical backstop on multi-billion-dollar accounts, resolving routing, switching, SD-WAN, and firewall escalations that exceeded junior consultant scope.
- Established implementation standards for a mixed CCNA / CCNP / CCIE bench across the firm's largest enterprise customers.

Technical Architect, Enterprise Networking & Hybrid Infrastructure

Feb 2023 to Feb 2024

Recruited as technical architect for the firm's largest account: a national healthcare network (1,000+ locations) with a 250-site M&A migration program.

- **Branch standardization:** Standardized the branch stack across acquired sites on VMware SD-WAN (VeloCloud / VMware Edge), Cradlepoint LTE failover, and Aruba switching / wireless managed via Aruba Central to eliminate configuration drift across acquired clinics.
- **Clinical workflow:** Directed integration of specialized medical endpoints and PIMS databases with zero-data-loss cutovers to maintain uninterrupted patient care.
- **Methodology:** Wrote the runbooks, QA gates, and pre-cutover validation procedures now mandated by the customer for all peer vendors.
- **Cutover command:** Commanded weekend cutover bridges with 20+ engineers and Smart Hands across up to 5 simultaneous sites, primary implementation engineer and final escalation authority on blockers.

Explore Industries (Leisure Pools)

Marion, SC

Global IT Director (promoted from IT Support Manager, North America)

Oct 2020 to 2024

Hands-on technical owner for global infrastructure across manufacturing sites in North America, Europe, and Australasia.

- **Network refresh:** Per CEO mandate, replaced 7+ year-old Cisco Meraki branch infrastructure across global manufacturing sites with a Ubiquiti-based architecture, eliminating recurring license fees and yielding ~\$500K in validated annual savings across M&A burst period while improving throughput and producing a rapid-deployment template for M&A integration.
- **Hybrid identity & remote access:** Built Active Directory / GPO + Entra ID (Azure AD) hybrid identity, Azure VNets, and Azure Virtual Desktop (AVD) to enable secure remote sessions from unmanaged devices without exposing internal systems.
- **Edge security:** Stood up firewall and VPN posture across global sites, including site-to-site IPsec between manufacturing locations and HQ.
- **Service desk build:** Stood up an internal help desk on Atlassian Jira / Jira Service Management for global ticket intake, queue routing, and SLA tracking across manufacturing sites.
- **M&A readiness:** Authored greenfield network designs and capital forecasts for new acquired sites, including local ISP sourcing and on-site support contracts; grew from 3 to 15 global locations during my tenure.

Beneteau

North America

Senior Network Administrator

Nov 2017 to Oct 2020

Hands-on senior network engineer recruited to remediate North American infrastructure leveraging carrier background.

- **SD-WAN modernization:** Migrated North American sites from MPLS to SD-WAN, achieving 100% uptime across the footprint.
- **National recognition:** Featured in Windstream's "Righting the Ship" success story for reducing system management time from 60 minutes to <3 minutes and driving down end-user ticket volume.
- **Pilot validation:** Selected to pilot enterprise RTX, but convinced Windstream to adopt EnGenius DECT in a live manufacturing environment, solved critical communication failures and influenced the carrier roadmap.

EARLIER CAREER

Sea Island Resort

Sea Island, GA

Director of IT / Asst. Director of AV

2016 to 2017

- Coordinated technology for >\$5M corporate events (PGA Tour, automotive boards); partnered with Secret Service and FBI on secure VIP infrastructure at a Forbes Five-Star property valued at >\$1B.

Windstream Enterprise

National

Team Lead, SMB Reseller & CLEC Support

2015 to 2016

- Promoted twice in under 12 months from VoIP Analyst II to Team Lead leading the newly formed CLEC support division; supported Sonus GSX softswitch, Lucent 5ESS, and Nortel DMS Class 5 platforms for wholesale partners with >\$2M/month billing exposure.